

StreamForge Creator Suite Documentation

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Notices

What's real and what's invented in this documentation set.

This documentation set is an unofficial, independent sample project built to demonstrate DITA content-reuse and taxonomy techniques. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or sponsored by any of the organizations behind the real product named below.

OBS Studio is a real, free and open-source software project. Its name and general feature set are used here factually, but this documentation is an independent sample, not the official OBS Studio manual.

The following four products—**StreamForge Capture**, **StreamForge Cloud**, **StreamForge Mobile**, and **StreamForge Studio Pro**—along with the umbrella name **StreamForge Creator Suite**, are entirely fictional. They were invented for this exercise to provide realistic multi-product scenarios for content reuse, taxonomy, and key-scoped map architecture. No such products exist.

OBS Studio

Interface Overview

A tour of the main OBS Studio window and where each panel lives.

The default OBS Studio layout has five main areas: the **Preview** pane showing your current scene, the **Scenes** list, the **Sources** list for the selected scene, the **Audio Mixer**, and the **Controls** panel with Start Recording/Streaming buttons.

- **Scenes panel** — every saved scene in the current scene collection.
- **Sources panel** — the sources that make up whichever scene is selected.
- **Audio Mixer** — a volume fader and mute button per audio source.
- **Controls** — Start/Stop Streaming, Start/Stop Recording, Settings, Exit.

Panels can be undocked, resized, or hidden from the `Docks` menu, and the whole layout can be saved and restored independently per scene collection.

Related concepts

[Recording a Video](#)

[Upgrading to Studio Pro](#) on page 13

Move from StreamForge Capture's simple layout to StreamForge Studio Pro's full scene, filter, and multi-camera toolset.

Installing OBS Studio

Download and install OBS Studio on Windows, macOS, or Linux.

A 64-bit system meeting [System Requirements](#).

The installer differs slightly per platform, but the first-run experience is the same everywhere: an Auto-Configuration Wizard benchmarks your hardware and proposes starting output settings.

1. Download the installer for your platform from the official OBS Studio site.

Windows

Run the `.exe` installer and accept the default install location unless you have a reason to change it.

macOS

Open the .dmg and drag OBS Studio into Applications.

Linux

Install via the distribution's package manager, Flatpak, or the official PPA, depending on your distribution.

2. Launch OBS Studio for the first time.
3. Complete the Auto-Configuration Wizard.

Choose **Optimize for recording** or **Optimize for streaming** depending on your primary use, then accept the benchmarked settings or adjust them.

OBS Studio opens with a default scene collection and one empty scene, ready for you to add sources.

System Requirements

Minimum and recommended specifications for OBS Studio.

These are minimums for a stable experience. Streaming or recording at higher resolutions, frame rates, or bitrates, or running multiple StreamForge products at once, will require more than the minimum.

	Minimum	Recommended
OS	Windows 10, macOS 12, or a current Linux distribution	Windows 11, macOS 14+, or current Linux distribution
GPU	DirectX 10.1 / OpenGL 3.3 compatible	Dedicated GPU with hardware encoder (NVENC/QuickSync/AMF)
RAM	4 GB	8 GB or more

Scenes and Sources

How OBS Studio's scene and source model works.

A **scene** is a named collection of one or more *sources*—windows, cameras, images, or other on-screen elements—arranged together on a canvas. Switching scenes changes everything visible on screen at once, instead of repositioning sources one at a time.

Most products let you build multiple scenes ahead of time and switch between them during a session or recording.

OBS Studio supports eleven source types, covering screen and window capture, game capture, camera and audio devices, images, media files, browser content, text, solid color, slideshows, and VLC-based playlists. Each source type has its own properties dialog with settings specific to that source.

Sources can be resized, cropped, and layered within a scene using the same transform handles regardless of source type, and the same source can be reused across multiple scenes without duplicating its underlying capture.

Adding a Display Capture Source

Capture an entire monitor as a source.

Display Capture mirrors an entire monitor, including anything that appears on top of other windows, such as notifications or cursor tooltips.

1. In the Sources panel, click the + button and choose **Display Capture**.
2. Name the source and click **OK**.

3. Choose which monitor to capture from the **Display** dropdown.
 4. Optionally enable **Capture Cursor**.
Turn this off if you plan to add a separate, styled cursor overlay later.
- The selected monitor appears in the current scene and updates live.

Adding a Window Capture Source

Capture a single application window instead of the whole screen.

Window Capture follows one window even if you move or resize it, and unlike Display Capture it won't show anything from other applications layered on top.

1. In the Sources panel, click **+** and choose **Window Capture**.
2. Select the target application from the **Window** dropdown.
The target application must already be running.
3. Choose a capture method if prompted.
Most modern applications work with the default method; older or hardware-accelerated applications sometimes need an alternate capture method to render correctly.

The chosen window appears in the scene and continues updating even if the window is minimized behind other windows (though not while fully minimized).

Adding a Game Capture Source

Capture a game at full frame rate with lower overhead than Window Capture.

Game Capture hooks directly into a game's rendering pipeline, which usually performs better than Window Capture for full-screen or borderless games.

1. In the Sources panel, click **+** and choose **Game Capture**.
2. Set **Mode** to **Capture specific window** or **Capture any fullscreen application**.
3. Launch or switch to the game.
4. Optional: Enable **Allow Transparency** if the game renders with an alpha channel and you need overlays to show through correctly.

The game's output appears in the scene once OBS detects a matching window.

See [Troubleshooting: Dropped Frames](#) if capture is choppy.

Filters Overview

Filters modify a single source's video or audio without affecting the rest of the scene.

Filters are attached to an individual source (or to a scene, for scene-wide effects) and are applied in order from top to bottom of the filter list. Video filters and audio filters are listed separately because a source can have both at once.

Common video filters include Chroma Key, Color Correction, Sharpen, Crop/Pad, Scroll, and LUT application. Common audio filters include Noise Suppression, Noise Gate, Compressor, and Limiter.

Note: Filter order matters. For example, a Crop/Pad filter placed before a Chroma Key filter crops the image before the key is calculated; placed after, it crops the already-keyed result.

Applying a Chroma Key Filter

Remove a solid-color background from a camera source.

A single, evenly lit solid-color backdrop behind the subject.

1. Right-click the camera source and choose **Filters**.

2. Under Video Filters, click **+** and choose **Chroma Key**.
3. Set **Key Color Type** to match your backdrop color.
4. Adjust **Similarity** and **Smoothness** until the background disappears cleanly without eating into the subject.

The backdrop becomes transparent, letting whatever is in scenes beneath it show through.

Applying a Color Correction Filter

Adjust brightness, contrast, saturation, and color balance of a source.

1. Right-click the source and choose **Filters**.
2. Under Video Filters, click **+** and choose **Color Correction**.
3. Adjust **Gamma**, **Contrast**, **Brightness**, and **Saturation** to taste.
4. Optional: Use the color wheel to shift overall color tint.

Changes apply live in the preview.

Applying a Noise Suppression Filter

Reduce steady background hiss or fan noise on a microphone source.

1. Right-click the microphone source in the Audio Mixer and choose **Filters**.
2. Click **+** and choose **Noise Suppression**.
3. Choose a suppression method and set the suppression level in decibels.
Start around -30 dB and adjust while monitoring audio, since too aggressive a setting can make speech sound muffled.
4. Optional: Add a **Noise Gate** filter above it to fully mute the mic below a volume threshold.

Recording a Video

Record your current scene to a local video file.

Recording captures exactly what the current scene shows, including all visible sources and unmuted audio, to a local video file. Nothing is uploaded or shared automatically—recording is entirely local.

1. Build the scene you want to record and confirm it's selected.
2. Check the Audio Mixer to confirm the correct microphone and desktop audio sources are unmuted at reasonable levels.
3. Click **Start Recording** in the Controls panel.
4. Perform the actions you want captured.
5. Click **Stop Recording** when finished.

The recording is saved to the output folder configured in **Settings > Output**.

Setting Up Streaming

Connect OBS Studio to a streaming service using RTMP.

OBS Studio streams to any service that accepts an RTMP or RTMPS ingest URL and stream key. The steps below use the generic **Custom...** service option, which works with any RTMP-compatible platform.

1. Open **Settings > Stream**.
2. Set **Service** to **Custom...**, or select your platform if it's listed by name.
3. Enter the **Server** (RTMP ingest URL) provided by your streaming platform.
4. Paste your platform's **Stream Key** into the Stream Key field.



CAUTION: Treat your stream key like a password. Anyone with it can stream to your channel.

5. Click **Apply**, then **Start Streaming** from the Controls panel.

Transitions

Control how OBS Studio animates the change from one scene to another.

A transition plays whenever you switch the active scene. OBS Studio ships with several built-in transitions:

Cut	Instant switch with no animation.
Fade	Crossfades from the old scene to the new one over a configurable duration.
Stinger	Plays a short video clip, typically with a transparent or matte section, to cover the switch.
Luma Wipe	Uses a grayscale image to control the wipe pattern between scenes.

The default transition and its duration are set from the dropdown and duration field between the Scenes and Sources panels, and can be overridden per scene using Quick Transitions.

Studio Mode

Preview a scene privately before it goes live or into the recording.

Studio Mode splits the preview into two panes: a private **Preview** pane on the left where you can select and adjust a scene, and a **Program** pane on the right showing exactly what's being recorded or streamed. Clicking **Transition** swaps Preview into Program using the active transition.

This is useful for checking a scene's layout, testing a source, or lining up a graphic before it becomes visible to your audience.

Using the Virtual Camera

Send your OBS Studio output to other applications as if it were a webcam.

Virtual Camera makes OBS Studio's program output selectable as a camera source inside video-calling and conferencing applications.

1. Click **Start Virtual Camera** in the Controls panel.
2. In your conferencing application, open its camera selection menu.
3. Choose **OBS Virtual Camera** as the video source.

The application now shows whatever OBS Studio's Program output is showing.

Full Settings Reference

Every settings category in OBS Studio and what it controls.

General

Theme, language, confirmation prompts on exit, and system tray behavior.

Stream

Streaming service selection, ingest server, and stream key.

Output

Encoder selection, bitrate, recording format and path, and replay buffer length. Available in Simple or Advanced mode.

Audio

Sample rate, channel layout, and up to four global audio devices in addition to per-source audio.

Video

Base (canvas) and output (scaled) resolution, downscale filter, and common and integer FPS values.

Hotkeys

Global keyboard shortcuts for scene switching, recording, streaming, muting, and more. See [Hotkeys](#) for the default bindings.

Advanced

Process priority, color format and space, network buffering, and automatic recovery settings for dropped frames.

Scene Collections and Profiles

Two independent ways to save and switch entire setups at once.

A **scene collection** is the full set of scenes and sources you've built. A **profile** is a full set of output, audio, and video settings. They're independent: you can pair any scene collection with any profile, which is useful when the same scenes need different output settings depending on where you're streaming from.

Both are managed from their respective menus, support duplicating an existing one as a starting point, and can be exported to a file and imported on another machine.

Hotkeys

Default global keyboard shortcuts, all of which are user-configurable.

Action	Default hotkey
Start/Stop Streaming	Not bound by default
Start/Stop Recording	Not bound by default
Save Replay Buffer	Not bound by default
Switch to Scene 1-9	Not bound by default
Push-to-talk / Push-to-mute	Not bound by default

All hotkeys are unbound out of the box to avoid conflicting with other applications; assign them from **Settings > Hotkeys**.

Plugins and Scripting Overview

Two ways to extend OBS Studio beyond its built-in features.

Plugins are compiled extensions, installed alongside OBS Studio, that can add new source types, filters, or output methods. They're installed by copying files into the OBS plugins directory or through a platform-specific installer.

Scripts are Lua or Python files loaded from **Tools > Scripts** that can automate scene switching, respond to events, or add simple custom behavior without recompiling anything.

Appendices

Appendix: Command-Line Arguments

Flags accepted when launching OBS Studio from a terminal or shortcut.

Argument	Effect
--startstreaming	Begins streaming immediately on launch.
--startrecording	Begins recording immediately on launch.
--collection "Name"	Launches with a specific scene collection active.
--profile "Name"	Launches with a specific profile active.
--minimize-to-tray	Starts minimized to the system tray.

Appendix: Supported File Formats

Recording container and image formats OBS Studio can write or read.

Recording containers

MP4, MOV, MKV, FLV, TS, and hybrid MP4 (a self-repairing variant recommended when recording long, unattended sessions).

Image source formats

PNG, JPG, BMP, GIF (including animated GIF playback), and TGA.

Troubleshooting

Troubleshooting: No Audio in Recording

The recorded file has video but no sound.

Playing back a finished recording produces picture with no audio track, or with a track that is silent.

The audio source was muted, or its volume fader was at zero, at the time of recording. Muting in the Audio Mixer is captured—OBS Studio records exactly what you would hear.

User

1. Check the Audio Mixer for a muted icon on the relevant source.
2. Unmute the source and confirm the fader is above zero.
3. Record a short test clip and play it back before recording anything longer.

The wrong audio device is assigned as the global Desktop Audio or Mic/Auxiliary device in Settings, so the intended device was never being captured at all.

User

1. Open **Settings > Audio**.
2. Confirm the correct devices are selected for Desktop Audio and Mic/Auxiliary Audio.

Troubleshooting: Dropped Frames

The stream stutters, or the status bar reports dropped frames.

OBS Studio's status bar shows a percentage of frames dropped, and the resulting stream or recording stutters or skips.

Rendering frames dropped: the CPU or GPU cannot keep up with the chosen output resolution, frame rate, or number of active sources and filters.

User

1. Lower the output resolution or frame rate in **Settings > Video**.
2. Reduce the number of active filters, especially GPU-intensive ones like Chroma Key at high resolution.
3. Switch to a hardware encoder if currently using software (x264) encoding.

Network frames dropped: the configured bitrate exceeds what the upload connection can sustain, so the network buffer overflows and frames are discarded before they reach the streaming service.

User

1. Run a real-world upload speed test, not just the number advertised by your ISP.
2. Lower the streaming bitrate in **Settings > Output** to comfortably below your measured upload speed.
3. Enable **Automatically reconnect** and a dynamic bitrate option if your encoder supports it.

Support and Contact

How to reach StreamForge support, the same across every product in the suite.

Support channels

Channel	Use for
Community forum	General questions, feature requests, troubleshooting help from other users
Support ticket	Account, billing, and licensing issues
Status page	Checking whether StreamForge Cloud is experiencing an outage

Response times

Free-tier requests are answered on a best-effort basis. Pro-tier accounts receive priority queuing on support tickets.

StreamForge Capture

Installing StreamForge Capture

Download and install StreamForge Capture on Windows or macOS.

StreamForge Capture has a single installer per platform and no auto-configuration wizard—it opens directly into a ready-to-use default scene.

1. Download the installer for your platform from the StreamForge site.
2. Run the installer and accept the default install location.
3. Launch StreamForge Capture.

StreamForge Capture opens with one default scene containing a webcam and microphone source, ready to record.

System Requirements

Minimum and recommended specifications for StreamForge Capture.

These are minimums for a stable experience. Streaming or recording at higher resolutions, frame rates, or bitrates, or running multiple StreamForge products at once, will require more than the minimum.

	Minimum	Recommended
OS	Windows 10 or macOS 12	Windows 11 or macOS 14+
RAM	2 GB	4 GB

Scenes and Sources

StreamForge Capture's simplified scene and source model.

A **scene** is a named collection of one or more *sources*—windows, cameras, images, or other on-screen elements—arranged together on a canvas. Switching scenes changes everything visible on screen at once, instead of repositioning sources one at a time.

In short: sources are the pieces, a scene is the arrangement.

StreamForge Capture deliberately supports only three source types—Webcam, Microphone, and Screen—compared to OBS Studio's eleven. There are no filters and no scripting; sources are added, resized, and arranged, and that's the whole model.

Capture also supports only one scene at a time rather than a saved collection of scenes, since its target use case is a single always-the-same webcam layout rather than switching between multiple setups.

Recording a Video

Record your current layout to a local video file.

Recording captures exactly what the current scene shows, including all visible sources and unmuted audio, to a local video file. Nothing is uploaded or shared automatically—recording is entirely local.

1. Arrange your Webcam, Microphone, and Screen sources as needed.

2. Check that the microphone level meter moves when you speak.
3. Click **Record**.
4. Click **Stop** when finished.

The recording is saved to your Videos folder.

Upgrading to Studio Pro

Move from StreamForge Capture's simple layout to StreamForge Studio Pro's full scene, filter, and multi-camera toolset.

StreamForge Studio Pro includes everything in StreamForge Capture, plus unlimited scenes, filters, multi-camera switching, advanced overlays, and team collaboration. Upgrading does not require reinstalling—Studio Pro reads your existing Capture layout on first launch.

1. Sign in to your StreamForge account and confirm your subscription includes the Pro tier.
See [Account and Licensing](#).
2. Install StreamForge Studio Pro alongside, or in place of, StreamForge Capture.
3. Launch Studio Pro and sign in with the same account.

Your existing Webcam, Microphone, and Screen sources appear in a new scene, and the full Pro feature set becomes available.

Related concepts

[Interface Overview](#) on page 4

A tour of the main OBS Studio window and where each panel lives.

[Multi-Camera Switching](#) on page 19

Switch live between multiple camera sources with dedicated preview tiles.

Support and Contact

How to reach StreamForge support, the same across every product in the suite.

Support channels

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Response times

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StreamForge Cloud

Account and Licensing

Every StreamForge product that touches the cloud shares one account and licensing system.

Creating your StreamForge account

A StreamForge account is a single sign-on identity that works across StreamForge Cloud, StreamForge Mobile, and StreamForge Studio Pro. Create one at the StreamForge account portal using an email address and password, or sign in with an existing Google or Apple identity.

Plans and tiers

StreamForge products ship in two tiers: **Free**, which covers core recording, capture, and upload functionality, and **Pro**, which unlocks multi-camera switching, advanced overlays, team collaboration, and higher cloud storage and transcoding limits. Tier is tied to the account, not the installed application, so signing in unlocks the same tier everywhere.

Activating a Pro license

A Pro license activates automatically the first time you sign in to a Pro-capable product with an account that has an active Pro subscription. No separate license key entry is required.

System Requirements

StreamForge Cloud runs entirely in a web browser—there is no desktop application to install.

These are minimums for a stable experience. Streaming or recording at higher resolutions, frame rates, or bitrates, or running multiple StreamForge products at once, will require more than the minimum.

	Requirement
Browser	A current version of any major browser with hardware video decoding enabled
Connection	Broadband recommended for uploading recordings above 1080p

Uploading a Recording

Send a local recording from OBS Studio, Capture, or Studio Pro to StreamForge Cloud.

1. Sign in to your StreamForge account at the Cloud web portal.
2. Click **Upload** and choose a video file from your computer.
3. Wait for the upload progress bar to complete.
Upload speed depends on your connection, not on StreamForge Cloud.
4. Once uploaded, the recording begins transcoding automatically.

The recording appears in your library once transcoding finishes, with a shareable link available immediately.

Sharing and Permissions

Control who can view or download an uploaded recording.

1. Open a recording in your library and click **Share**.
2. Choose a visibility level: **Private**, **Unlisted** (anyone with the link), or **Public** (listed on your profile).
3. Optional: Toggle **Allow Download** to let viewers save the file locally.
4. Optional: Invite specific collaborators by email to grant edit access.
Inviting collaborators with edit access is a Pro-tier feature.

Transcoding Settings Reference

What happens to a recording after you upload it, and what you can control.

Automatic renditions

Every upload is automatically transcoded into 1080p, 720p, and 480p renditions so viewers get a resolution matching their connection.

Pro-tier options

Pro accounts can additionally request a 4K rendition (source permitting) and can disable the lower renditions to save storage.

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StreamForge Mobile

Installing StreamForge Mobile

Install the StreamForge Mobile companion app on iOS or Android.

1. Open the App Store (iOS) or Google Play (Android) on your phone.

2. Search for **StreamForge Mobile** and install it.
3. Open the app and sign in with your StreamForge account.

StreamForge Mobile opens to a pairing screen, ready to connect to a desktop product on the same network.

System Requirements

Minimum phone OS versions for StreamForge Mobile.

These are minimums for a stable experience. Streaming or recording at higher resolutions, frame rates, or bitrates, or running multiple StreamForge products at once, will require more than the minimum.

	Minimum version
iOS	iOS 16
Android	Android 11

Pairing with a Desktop Product

Connect StreamForge Mobile to OBS Studio, StreamForge Capture, or StreamForge Studio Pro on the same network.

The phone and the computer running the desktop product must be on the same Wi-Fi network, and the desktop product must be running.

1. On the desktop product, open its companion pairing menu and note the six-digit pairing code shown.
2. In StreamForge Mobile, tap **Pair New Device**.
3. Enter the six-digit code.

The phone appears as an available camera and remote-control source in the desktop product, and the desktop product's scenes appear on the phone for remote monitoring.

Remote Camera Control

Use your phone as a camera source and control it remotely from the touch interface.

Once paired, StreamForge Mobile can act as a wireless camera source, and its touch controls let you adjust the shot without touching the phone itself once it's mounted.

1. On the phone, tap **Start Camera**.
2. Use the on-screen pinch gesture to zoom, and drag to pan within the sensor's field of view.
3. Optional: Tap the focus reticle on a subject to lock focus and exposure to that point.

The paired desktop product receives the video feed as a live camera source that updates as you adjust framing from the phone.

Monitoring a Live Session

Watch your program output and audio levels from your phone while streaming or recording.

1. With a device paired, tap **Monitor** in StreamForge Mobile.
2. View the live program output, current scene name, elapsed recording or stream time, and audio level meters.
3. Optional: Tap a scene thumbnail to switch the desktop product to that scene remotely.

Account and Licensing

Every StreamForge product that touches the cloud shares one account and licensing system.

Creating your StreamForge account

A StreamForge account is a single sign-on identity that works across StreamForge Cloud, StreamForge Mobile, and StreamForge Studio Pro. Create one at the StreamForge account portal using an email address and password, or sign in with an existing Google or Apple identity.

Plans and tiers

StreamForge products ship in two tiers: **Free**, which covers core recording, capture, and upload functionality, and **Pro**, which unlocks multi-camera switching, advanced overlays, team collaboration, and higher cloud storage and transcoding limits. Tier is tied to the account, not the installed application, so signing in unlocks the same tier everywhere.

Activating a Pro license

A Pro license activates automatically the first time you sign in to a Pro-capable product with an account that has an active Pro subscription. No separate license key entry is required.

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StreamForge Studio Pro

Interface Overview

A tour of the main OBS Studio window and where each panel lives.

The default OBS Studio layout has five main areas: the **Preview** pane showing your current scene, the **Scenes** list, the **Sources** list for the selected scene, the **Audio Mixer**, and the **Controls** panel with Start Recording/Streaming buttons.

- **Scenes panel** — every saved scene in the current scene collection.
- **Sources panel** — the sources that make up whichever scene is selected.

- **Audio Mixer** — a volume fader and mute button per audio source.
- **Controls** — Start/Stop Streaming, Start/Stop Recording, Settings, Exit.

Panels can be undocked, resized, or hidden from the `Docks` menu, and the whole layout can be saved and restored independently per scene collection.

Related concepts

[Recording a Video](#)

[Upgrading to Studio Pro](#) on page 13

Move from StreamForge Capture's simple layout to StreamForge Studio Pro's full scene, filter, and multi-camera toolset.

System Requirements

Minimum and recommended specifications for OBS Studio.

These are minimums for a stable experience. Streaming or recording at higher resolutions, frame rates, or bitrates, or running multiple StreamForge products at once, will require more than the minimum.

	Minimum	Recommended
OS	Windows 10, macOS 12, or a current Linux distribution	Windows 11, macOS 14+, or current Linux distribution
GPU	DirectX 10.1 / OpenGL 3.3 compatible	Dedicated GPU with hardware encoder (NVENC/QuickSync/AMF)
RAM	4 GB	8 GB or more

Scenes and Sources

How OBS Studio's scene and source model works.

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Most products let you build multiple scenes ahead of time and switch between them during a session or recording.

OBS Studio supports eleven source types, covering screen and window capture, game capture, camera and audio devices, images, media files, browser content, text, solid color, slideshows, and VLC-based playlists. Each source type has its own properties dialog with settings specific to that source.

Sources can be resized, cropped, and layered within a scene using the same transform handles regardless of source type, and the same source can be reused across multiple scenes without duplicating its underlying capture.

Adding a Display Capture Source

Capture an entire monitor as a source.

Display Capture mirrors an entire monitor, including anything that appears on top of other windows, such as notifications or cursor tooltips.

1. In the Sources panel, click the **+** button and choose **Display Capture**.
2. Name the source and click **OK**.
3. Choose which monitor to capture from the **Display** dropdown.

4. Optionally enable **Capture Cursor**.

Turn this off if you plan to add a separate, styled cursor overlay later.

The selected monitor appears in the current scene and updates live.

Adding a Window Capture Source

Capture a single application window instead of the whole screen.

Window Capture follows one window even if you move or resize it, and unlike Display Capture it won't show anything from other applications layered on top.

1. In the Sources panel, click **+** and choose **Window Capture**.

2. Select the target application from the **Window** dropdown.

The target application must already be running.

3. Choose a capture method if prompted.

Most modern applications work with the default method; older or hardware-accelerated applications sometimes need an alternate capture method to render correctly.

The chosen window appears in the scene and continues updating even if the window is minimized behind other windows (though not while fully minimized).

Adding a Game Capture Source

Capture a game at full frame rate with lower overhead than Window Capture.

Game Capture hooks directly into a game's rendering pipeline, which usually performs better than Window Capture for full-screen or borderless games.

1. In the Sources panel, click **+** and choose **Game Capture**.

2. Set **Mode** to **Capture specific window** or **Capture any fullscreen application**.

3. Launch or switch to the game.

4. Optional: Enable **Allow Transparency** if the game renders with an alpha channel and you need overlays to show through correctly.

The game's output appears in the scene once OBS detects a matching window.

See [Troubleshooting: Dropped Frames](#) if capture is choppy.

Multi-Camera Switching

Switch live between multiple camera sources with dedicated preview tiles.

The Multi-Camera panel shows a live preview tile for every camera source in the current scene at once, letting you cut between them without hunting through the Sources list.

1. Open the **Multi-Camera** panel from the **Docks** menu.

2. Assign a numbered slot to each camera source you want quick access to.

3. Click a tile, or press its assigned number key, to bring that camera to Program.

The selected camera becomes the active video source with the currently configured transition.

Related concepts

[Recording a Video](#)

[Upgrading to Studio Pro](#) on page 13

Move from StreamForge Capture's simple layout to StreamForge Studio Pro's full scene, filter, and multi-camera toolset.

Filters Overview

Filters modify a single source's video or audio without affecting the rest of the scene.

Filters are attached to an individual source (or to a scene, for scene-wide effects) and are applied in order from top to bottom of the filter list. Video filters and audio filters are listed separately because a source can have both at once.

Common video filters include Chroma Key, Color Correction, Sharpen, Crop/Pad, Scroll, and LUT application. Common audio filters include Noise Suppression, Noise Gate, Compressor, and Limiter.

Note: Filter order matters. For example, a Crop/Pad filter placed before a Chroma Key filter crops the image before the key is calculated; placed after, it crops the already-keyed result.

Applying a Chroma Key Filter

Remove a solid-color background from a camera source.

A single, evenly lit solid-color backdrop behind the subject.

1. Right-click the camera source and choose **Filters**.
2. Under Video Filters, click + and choose **Chroma Key**.
3. Set **Key Color Type** to match your backdrop color.
4. Adjust **Similarity** and **Smoothness** until the background disappears cleanly without eating into the subject.

The backdrop becomes transparent, letting whatever is in scenes beneath it show through.

Applying a Color Correction Filter

Adjust brightness, contrast, saturation, and color balance of a source.

1. Right-click the source and choose **Filters**.
2. Under Video Filters, click + and choose **Color Correction**.
3. Adjust **Gamma**, **Contrast**, **Brightness**, and **Saturation** to taste.
4. Optional: Use the color wheel to shift overall color tint.

Changes apply live in the preview.

Applying a Noise Suppression Filter

Reduce steady background hiss or fan noise on a microphone source.

1. Right-click the microphone source in the Audio Mixer and choose **Filters**.
2. Click + and choose **Noise Suppression**.
3. Choose a suppression method and set the suppression level in decibels.
Start around -30 dB and adjust while monitoring audio, since too aggressive a setting can make speech sound muffled.
4. Optional: Add a **Noise Gate** filter above it to fully mute the mic below a volume threshold.

Advanced Overlays

Data-driven overlays that update automatically during a session.

Advanced Overlays are template-based graphics—lower thirds, score bugs, countdown timers, alert banners—that bind to live data sources such as a clock, a manually-triggered counter, or an incoming webhook, instead of being static images.

Overlay templates are edited in a visual layout tool and can be reused across scenes, with per-scene overrides for the bound data source.

Recording a Video

Record your current scene to a local video file.

Recording captures exactly what the current scene shows, including all visible sources and unmuted audio, to a local video file. Nothing is uploaded or shared automatically—recording is entirely local.

1. Build the scene you want to record and confirm it's selected.
2. Check the Audio Mixer to confirm the correct microphone and desktop audio sources are unmuted at reasonable levels.
3. Click **Start Recording** in the Controls panel.
4. Perform the actions you want captured.
5. Click **Stop Recording** when finished.

The recording is saved to the output folder configured in **Settings > Output**.

Setting Up Streaming

Connect OBS Studio to a streaming service using RTMP.

OBS Studio streams to any service that accepts an RTMP or RTMPS ingest URL and stream key. The steps below use the generic **Custom...** service option, which works with any RTMP-compatible platform.

1. Open **Settings > Stream**.
2. Set **Service** to **Custom...**, or select your platform if it's listed by name.
3. Enter the **Server** (RTMP ingest URL) provided by your streaming platform.
4. Paste your platform's **Stream Key** into the Stream Key field.



CAUTION: Treat your stream key like a password. Anyone with it can stream to your channel.

5. Click **Apply**, then **Start Streaming** from the Controls panel.

Transitions

Control how OBS Studio animates the change from one scene to another.

A transition plays whenever you switch the active scene. OBS Studio ships with several built-in transitions:

Cut	Instant switch with no animation.
Fade	Crossfades from the old scene to the new one over a configurable duration.
Stinger	Plays a short video clip, typically with a transparent or matte section, to cover the switch.
Luma Wipe	Uses a grayscale image to control the wipe pattern between scenes.

The default transition and its duration are set from the dropdown and duration field between the Scenes and Sources panels, and can be overridden per scene using Quick Transitions.

Studio Mode

Preview a scene privately before it goes live or into the recording.

Studio Mode splits the preview into two panes: a private **Preview** pane on the left where you can select and adjust a scene, and a **Program** pane on the right showing exactly what's being recorded or streamed. Clicking **Transition** swaps Preview into Program using the active transition.

This is useful for checking a scene's layout, testing a source, or lining up a graphic before it becomes visible to your audience.

Using the Virtual Camera

Send your OBS Studio output to other applications as if it were a webcam.

Virtual Camera makes OBS Studio's program output selectable as a camera source inside video-calling and conferencing applications.

1. Click **Start Virtual Camera** in the Controls panel.
2. In your conferencing application, open its camera selection menu.
3. Choose **OBS Virtual Camera** as the video source.

The application now shows whatever OBS Studio's Program output is showing.

Full Settings Reference

Every settings category in OBS Studio and what it controls.

General

Theme, language, confirmation prompts on exit, and system tray behavior.

Stream

Streaming service selection, ingest server, and stream key.

Output

Encoder selection, bitrate, recording format and path, and replay buffer length. Available in Simple or Advanced mode.

Audio

Sample rate, channel layout, and up to four global audio devices in addition to per-source audio.

Video

Base (canvas) and output (scaled) resolution, downscale filter, and common and integer FPS values.

Hotkeys

Global keyboard shortcuts for scene switching, recording, streaming, muting, and more. See [Hotkeys](#) for the default bindings.

Advanced

Process priority, color format and space, network buffering, and automatic recovery settings for dropped frames.

Scene Collections and Profiles

Two independent ways to save and switch entire setups at once.

A **scene collection** is the full set of scenes and sources you've built. A **profile** is a full set of output, audio, and video settings. They're independent: you can pair any scene collection with any profile, which is useful when the same scenes need different output settings depending on where you're streaming from.

Both are managed from their respective menus, support duplicating an existing one as a starting point, and can be exported to a file and imported on another machine.

Hotkeys

Default global keyboard shortcuts, all of which are user-configurable.

Action	Default hotkey
Start/Stop Streaming	Not bound by default
Start/Stop Recording	Not bound by default
Save Replay Buffer	Not bound by default
Switch to Scene 1-9	Not bound by default
Push-to-talk / Push-to-mute	Not bound by default

All hotkeys are unbound out of the box to avoid conflicting with other applications; assign them from **Settings > Hotkeys**.

Plugins and Scripting Overview

Two ways to extend OBS Studio beyond its built-in features.

Plugins are compiled extensions, installed alongside OBS Studio, that can add new source types, filters, or output methods. They're installed by copying files into the OBS plugins directory or through a platform-specific installer.

Scripts are Lua or Python files loaded from **Tools > Scripts** that can automate scene switching, respond to events, or add simple custom behavior without recompiling anything.

Team Collaboration

Share a scene collection and control access to it across a team.

A Studio Pro scene collection can be shared with teammates on the same StreamForge account's team. Shared collections sync automatically, and role-based permissions control who can edit sources and filters versus who can only switch scenes during a live session.

Two roles are available: **Editor**, who can change anything in the shared collection, and **Operator**, who can switch scenes and start/stop recording or streaming but cannot modify sources or filters.

Account and Licensing

Every StreamForge product that touches the cloud shares one account and licensing system.

Creating your StreamForge account

A StreamForge account is a single sign-on identity that works across StreamForge Cloud, StreamForge Mobile, and StreamForge Studio Pro. Create one at the StreamForge account portal using an email address and password, or sign in with an existing Google or Apple identity.

Plans and tiers

StreamForge products ship in two tiers: **Free**, which covers core recording, capture, and upload functionality, and **Pro**, which unlocks multi-camera switching, advanced overlays, team collaboration, and higher cloud storage and transcoding limits. Tier is tied to the account, not the installed application, so signing in unlocks the same tier everywhere.

Activating a Pro license

A Pro license activates automatically the first time you sign in to a Pro-capable product with an account that has an active Pro subscription. No separate license key entry is required.

License Activation

How Studio Pro's Pro-exclusive features unlock.

A Pro license activates automatically the first time you sign in to a Pro-capable product with an account that has an active Pro subscription. No separate license key entry is required.

Until activation completes, Studio Pro runs with Multi-Camera Switching, Advanced Overlays, and Team Collaboration disabled, and behaves like StreamForge Capture with the full OBS Studio-style scene and filter model still available.

Appendices

Appendix: Command-Line Arguments

Flags accepted when launching OBS Studio from a terminal or shortcut.

Argument	Effect
--startstreaming	Begins streaming immediately on launch.
--startrecording	Begins recording immediately on launch.
--collection "Name"	Launches with a specific scene collection active.
--profile "Name"	Launches with a specific profile active.
--minimize-to-tray	Starts minimized to the system tray.

Appendix: Supported File Formats

Recording container and image formats OBS Studio can write or read.

Recording containers

MP4, MOV, MKV, FLV, TS, and hybrid MP4 (a self-repairing variant recommended when recording long, unattended sessions).

Image source formats

PNG, JPG, BMP, GIF (including animated GIF playback), and TGA.

Troubleshooting

Troubleshooting: No Audio in Recording

The recorded file has video but no sound.

Playing back a finished recording produces picture with no audio track, or with a track that is silent.

The audio source was muted, or its volume fader was at zero, at the time of recording. Muting in the Audio Mixer is captured—OBS Studio records exactly what you would hear.

User

1. Check the Audio Mixer for a muted icon on the relevant source.
2. Unmute the source and confirm the fader is above zero.
3. Record a short test clip and play it back before recording anything longer.

The wrong audio device is assigned as the global Desktop Audio or Mic/Auxiliary device in Settings, so the intended device was never being captured at all.

User

1. Open **Settings > Audio**.
2. Confirm the correct devices are selected for Desktop Audio and Mic/Auxiliary Audio.

Troubleshooting: Dropped Frames

The stream stutters, or the status bar reports dropped frames.

OBS Studio's status bar shows a percentage of frames dropped, and the resulting stream or recording stutters or skips.

Rendering frames dropped: the CPU or GPU cannot keep up with the chosen output resolution, frame rate, or number of active sources and filters.

User

1. Lower the output resolution or frame rate in **Settings > Video**.
2. Reduce the number of active filters, especially GPU-intensive ones like Chroma Key at high resolution.
3. Switch to a hardware encoder if currently using software (x264) encoding.

Network frames dropped: the configured bitrate exceeds what the upload connection can sustain, so the network buffer overflows and frames are discarded before they reach the streaming service.

User

1. Run a real-world upload speed test, not just the number advertised by your ISP.
2. Lower the streaming bitrate in **Settings > Output** to comfortably below your measured upload speed.
3. Enable **Automatically reconnect** and a dynamic bitrate option if your encoder supports it.

Support and Contact

How to reach StreamForge support, the same across every product in the suite.

Support channels

Channel	Use for
Community forum	General questions, feature requests, troubleshooting help from other users
Support ticket	Account, billing, and licensing issues
Status page	Checking whether StreamForge Cloud is experiencing an outage

Response times

Free-tier requests are answered on a best-effort basis. Pro-tier accounts receive priority queuing on support tickets.